

Savvy consumers, who were used to saving money on groceries with coupons, noticed the difference, too. While coupon redemption rose 34.7 percent from 2008 to 2011, third quarter statistics in 2012 showed a 17 percent decrease in redemption rate. No wonder; we were still able to save on our razors and shampoo, but just as prices on groceries were rising, fewer food coupons were being offered. With fewer coupons and a lower average face value of those offered, using coupons apparently became less appealing.

Where does the modern consumer find most of their coupons? Well, some things never change. Like the first Coca-Cola and Post cereal coupons, the majority, nearly 90 percent, are still found in the Sunday newspaper. Then there are the coupons found in store ads, on the packages, inside magazines, in direct mail and store handouts, and of course, the electronic and digital coupons. All of these categories have experienced growth since 2005, but none at the level of Internet-printed and mobile coupons. With the proliferation of the Internet, the face of couponing has naturally morphed somewhat. The Internet has opened up a whole new world for customer savings (and for fraud, but more on that later). IndustryStatistics.com reported in an April 2011 internet retailer report that 74 percent of consumers search multiple online coupon resources each week, identifying four major types of online coupons:

- **Internet-Printed coupons:** Internet-printed (IP) coupons are one of the fastest emerging developments in the world of savings. Internet printed coupons are just what they sound like: coupons that can be downloaded and printed out to take to the store.